COMPREHENSION

Comprehension

Direction :- [Q .1. to Q .297.] Read the following passages and answer the questions that follow.

Examination wise Questions

SSC CGL 2025 Tier - I

SET - 1 [Q .1. to Q .5.]

The burgeoning field of epigenetics has revolutionized our understanding of heredity, extending beyond the simplistic Mendelian model of gene transmission. Traditionally, genetics focused on the DNA sequence itself as the sole determinant of an organism's traits. However, epigenetics reveals that environmental factors, lifestyle choices, and even historical traumas can profoundly influence gene expression without altering
the underlying DNA code. These epigenetic
modifications – such as DNA methylation and histone acetylation – act as molecular switches, turning genes on or off, or modulating their activity levels. This plasticity means that an identical twin, despite sharing an identical genome with their sibling, can develop different susceptibilities to disease or even exhibit distinct personality traits due to divergent epigenetic landscapes shaped by their individual experiences. Furthermore, some epigenetic tags can be inherited across generations, implying that the choices and environments of our ancestors might subtly predispose us to certain conditions or capabilities.

This intergenerational inheritance challenges long-held notions of fixed genetic destiny, suggesting a dynamic interplay between nature and nurture where nurture can directly influence which parts of our nature are expressed. The implications are far-reaching, from developing novel therapeutic strategies for diseases like cancer to reframing public health interventions that consider
transgenerational
environmental
impacts.

Understanding epigenetics compels us to view biological inheritance not as a rigid blueprint, but as a malleable score being continuously re-orchestrated by life itself.

SSC CGL 12/09/2025 (Shift 1)

Q.1. What is the main focus of epigenetics according to the passage?

(a) Altering DNA sequences directly.

(b) The study of gene expression without changing DNA.

(c) Mendelian patterns of inheritance.

(d) Developing new genetic diseases.

Q.2. What do DNA methylation and histone acetylation do in epigenetics?

(a) They change the DNA sequence.

(b) They turn genes on or off.

(c) They create new diseases.

(d) They make genetic traits unchangeable.

Q.3. How does epigenetics affect our idea of fixed genetic destiny?

(a) It shows DNA sequences always change.

(b) It shows the environment can change inherited traits.

(c) It proves all twins are exactly alike.

(d) It only focuses on physical looks.

Q.4. What does "malleable score" mean for our genetic inheritance?

(a) A set plan that cannot be changed.

(b) A fixed musical score.

(c) A flexible genetic plan that life experiences can change.

(d) Strict rules from our ancestors.

Q.5. Which of these is NOT something we learn from epigenetics, according to the passage?

(a) New ways to treat diseases.

(b) New ideas for public health.

(c) That genes are always stronger than environment.

(d) How environment affects future generations.

SET - 2 [Q .6. to Q .10.]

The digital divide, a chasm separating those with access to modern information and communication technology (ICT) from those without, poses a significant challenge to equitable development. While the internet offers unparalleled opportunities for education, economic growth, and civic participation, billions globally remain unconnected or lack the necessary digital literacy to leverage its benefits. This divide is

not merely about access to hardware like smartphones or computers; it encompasses disparities in broadband connectivity, affordability, quality of service, and the skills needed to effectively navigate the digital landscape. In developed nations, the divide often manifests as a gap between urban and rural areas, or between different socio-economic groups. In developing countries, it is a more fundamental barrier, with entire regions lacking basic infrastructure. The consequences are profound: those on the wrong side of the divide face reduced educational opportunities, limited access to remote work, exclusion from e-governance services, and a diminished voice in the global conversation. Bridging this gap requires multi-faceted interventions, including government initiatives to expand infrastructure, subsidies to make internet access affordable, and comprehensive digital literacy programmes. Furthermore, content must be culturally relevant and multilingual to ensure inclusivity. Ultimately, ensuring universal access and digital competence is not just about technology; it's about fostering social equality and ensuring that no one is left behind in the rapidly advancing digital age.

SSC CGL 12/09/2025 (Shift 2)

Q.6. What is the main idea of the passage?

(a) The rise of new technologies.

(b) The challenges and consequences of the digital divide.

(c) The benefits of fast internet.

(d) How governments provide technology.

Q.7. What does the "digital divide" primarily refer to?

(a) A gap between old and new technology.

(b) The difference in access to modern technology and related skills.

(c) The separation of digital and analogue devices.

(d) A boundary between online and offline activities.

Q.8. Besides hardware, what other factors contribute to the digital divide?

(a) Only the cost of software.

(b) Broadband quality and digital skills.

(c) The number of available apps.

(d) The speed of social media.

Q.9. What is one major consequence for those on the "wrong side" of the digital divide?

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(a) Increased opportunities for remote work.

(b) Better access to e-governance services.

(c) Reduced educational opportunities.

(d) A louder voice in global conversations.

Q.10. What is one suggested solution to bridge the digital divide?

(a) Reducing the number of available online platforms.

(b) Governments expanding infrastructure.

(c) Focusing only on urban areas.

(d) Limiting access to content.

SET - 3 [Q .11. to Q .15.]

The symbiotic relationship between flowering plants and their pollinators is a cornerstone of global biodiversity and ecosystem stability. Pollinators, primarily insects like bees, butterflies, and moths, but also birds and bats, play a crucial role in the reproduction of over 80% of the world's flowering plants, including many food crops essential for human sustenance. As these animals visit flowers to feed on nectar or pollen, they inadvertently transfer pollen grains from one flower to another, enabling fertilization. This intricate dance has evolved over millions of years, leading to highly specialized adaptations in both plants and pollinators. For instance, some flowers have evolved specific shapes, colors, or scents to attract particular pollinators, while pollinators have developed specialized mouthparts or behaviors to access the rewards offered by these flowers.

However, this vital relationship is under severe threat from various anthropogenic factors. Habitat loss due to urbanization and agriculture, pesticide use (especially neonicotinoids), climate change altering bloom times, and the spread of diseases and invasive species are collectively contributing to a dramatic decline in pollinator populations worldwide. The consequences of this decline are far-reaching. Beyond the ecological impact on wild plant reproduction, there are significant economic implications for agriculture. Many fruits, vegetables, and nuts

rely heavily on animal pollination, and a reduction in pollinator services can lead to lower yields, reduced quality, and increased food costs. Scientists are actively researching solutions, from promoting pollinator-friendly farming practices and creating urban pollinator gardens to developing less harmful pest management strategies and conserving natural habitats. Understanding and protecting these unsung heroes of our ecosystems is paramount for food security and the health of our planet.

SSC CGL 12/09/2025 (Shift 3)

Q.11. What is the central role of pollinators in ecosystems, as described in the passage?

(a) To decompose organic matter.

(b) To facilitate plant reproduction.

(c) To regulate water cycles.

(d) To control pest populations.

Q.12. According to the passage, what type of adaptations have plants developed to attract pollinators?

(a) Root structures

(b) Specific shapes, colors, or scents

(c) Photosynthetic efficiency(d) Drought resistance

Q.13. Which of the following is NOT listed as a threat to pollinator populations ?

(a) Habitat loss

(b) Pesticide use

(c) Increased rainfall

(d) Climate change

Q.14. What are the economic implications of declining pollinator populations mentioned in the passage ?

(a) Increased timber production

(b) Lower crop yields and higher food costs

(c) Decreased demand for agricultural labor

(d) Greater reliance on fossil fuels

Q.15. What is suggested as a solution to protect pollinators ?

(a) Encouraging deforestation

(b) Developing more harmful pest management strategies

(c) Promoting pollinator-friendly farming practices

(d) Reducing global trade

SET - 4 [Q .16. to Q .20.]

The air in the kitchen was thick with unspoken words, heavier than the simmering stew on the hob. Fifteen-year-old Liam stared at his phone, thumb scrolling endlessly, while his mother, Sarah, meticulously arranged vegetables on a chopping board, each slice a deliberate effort to avoid eye contact. It had been like this for weeks, ever since the text message, the one that splintered their comfortable silence. "Why can't you just talk to me?" Sarah's voice was low, strained, finally breaking the quiet. Liam flinched, his jaw tightening. "There's nothing to talk about." A familiar, brick-wall response. He knew what she wanted – an explanation for his sudden withdrawal, the late nights, the abrupt change in his friend group. But how could he explain the pressure, the constant barrage of judgment from online 'friends'

he barely knew, the relentless need to project an image of effortless cool ?

He remembered the first time he'd felt the sting of exclusion – a meme, shared widely in his class group chat, subtly mocking his older brother's passion for chess. He'd laughed along, a hollow, uncomfortable sound, desperate to fit in. Then came the 'dares,' escalating from minor pranks to something that made his stomach clench with fear. He'd tried to pull away, to mute the notifications, but the fear of being truly alone, ostracized from the only social circle he currently had, was suffocating. His old friends, the ones he'd shared genuine laughter with, felt distant, almost alien now. Sarah sighed, a sound of profound weariness. "Liam, I see you. I see you pulling away, shutting down. Whatever it is, we can face it together." He heard the tremor in her voice, the genuine concern, but a powerful knot of shame and fear kept his lips sealed. He glanced up, his eyes meeting hers for a fleeting second – a cavern of unspoken anxiety reflected in his gaze before he retreated back behind the glow of his screen, the silent battle raging on.

SSC CGL 13/09/2025 (Shift 1)

Q.16. What is the main reason for the tension between Liam and his mother, Sarah ?

(a) Liam's poor academic performance.

(b) A recent argument about chores.

(c) Liam's unexplained withdrawal and behavioral changes.

(d) Sarah's disapproval of Liam's old friends.

Q.17. What caused Liam to initially participate in activities he was uncomfortable with ?

(a) A genuine interest in pranks and dares.

(b) Pressure from his mother.

(c) The fear of exclusion and desire to fit in.

(d) His older brother's influence.

Q.18. How does Liam's interaction with his old friends compare to his current social circle ?

(a) His old friends are closer to him now.

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Comprehension

(b) His current social circle offers more genuine laughter.

(c) His old friends feel distant, almost alien now.

(d) He has completely cut off communication with his old friends.

Q.19. What emotional barrier prevents Liam from opening up to his mother ?

(a) Anger and resentment.

(b) A powerful knot of shame and fear.

(c) A desire for independence.

(d) Lack of trust in his mother.

Q.20. What is the author's primary purpose in writing this passage ?

(a) To criticize parental overreach in adolescent lives.

(b) To highlight the dangers of excessive screen time.

(c) To explore the internal and external pressures teenagers face in social dynamics.

(d) To advocate for stricter rules regarding online communication.

SET - 5 [Q .21. to Q .25.]

The perennial discussion surrounding the value of a liberal arts education in a technologically driven world often pits practical, vocational training against broader intellectual development. Critics argue that in an era demanding specialized skills and immediate job readiness, degrees in fields like philosophy, literature, or history are impractical and fail to equip graduates for the modern workforce. They emphasize the need for STEM (Science, Technology, Engineering, and Mathematics) fields, which directly contribute to economic growth and offer clearer career paths with higher earning potential, asserting that a focus on specific, marketable skills is the most efficient route to professional success.

However, proponents of a liberal arts education contend that its value lies precisely in its capacity to cultivate adaptable, critical thinkers—qualities that are increasingly vital in a rapidly changing global landscape. Instead of narrowly focusing on 'what to think,' a liberal arts curriculum teaches 'how to think.' It exposes students to a wide range of disciplines, fostering intellectual

curiosity,

analytical
reasoning,
effective
communication, and problem-solving abilities that transcend specific industries or technologies. Graduates learn to interpret complex information, articulate persuasive arguments, understand diverse cultural contexts, and approach challenges from multiple perspectives—skills that are foundational for leadership, innovation, and civic engagement.

In a world where automation and AI are poised to transform many specialized jobs, the uniquely human capacities developed through a liberal arts education—creativity, ethical reasoning, empathy, and holistic understanding —become more, not less, valuable. Employers increasingly seek individuals who can adapt to new challenges, collaborate effectively, and contribute to organizational culture, rather than merely possessing a narrow technical skill set that might quickly become obsolete.

Therefore, a liberal arts education, far from being impractical, provides a robust intellectual toolkit that prepares individuals not just for a first job, but for a lifetime of learning, career transitions, and meaningful contributions to society.

SSC CGL 13/09/2025 (Shift 2)

Q.21. What is the primary argument made by critics against a liberal arts education?

(a) It is too expensive compared to STEM degrees.

(b) It fails to provide immediate job readiness and specialized

skills for the modern workforce.

(c) It does not encourage intellectual curiosity.

(d) It focuses too much on science and technology.

Q.22. According to proponents, what is a key benefit of a liberal arts curriculum regarding critical thinking?

(a) It teaches students 'what to think'.

(b) It narrowly focuses on specific industry skills.

(c) It teaches students 'how to think'.

(d) It primarily emphasizes rote memorization.

Q.23. Which of the following is NOT listed as a skill fostered by a liberal arts education ?

(a) Analytical reasoning

(b) Effective communication

(c) Problem-solving abilities (d) Specialized vocational training

Q.24. In the context of automation and AI, what does the passage suggest about the value of uniquely human capacities developed through liberal arts ?

(a) They become less relevant.

(b) They become more valuable.

(c) They are replaced by technical skills.

(d) They are only useful in non-profit sectors.

Q.25. What do employers increasingly seek, according to the passage, in a rapidly changing world ?

(a) Individuals with only a narrow technical skill set.

(b) Individuals who exclusively specialize in one technological field.

(c) Individuals who can adapt to new challenges and collaborate effectively.

(d) Individuals who avoid career transitions.

SET - 6 [Q .26. to Q .30.]

With the rapid advancement of digital technology, reading habits have undergone a dramatic transformation. A few decades ago, printed books and newspapers were the primary sources of information and leisure reading. Today, digital screens dominate our lives, offering instant access to e-books, online articles, and news portals. While this shift has made reading more convenient, it has also raised concerns about declining attention spans and reduced comprehension. Researchers suggest that reading on screens often leads to superficial engagement, as readers tend to skim rather than absorb information deeply. Printed books, on the other hand, encourage focus and retention through a more immersive experience.

Despite these concerns, digital reading has several undeniable advantages. It allows users to carry thousands of books in one device, provides built-in dictionaries for quick reference, and ensures accessibility for people with visual impairments through adjustable fonts and audio support. Moreover, digital platforms promote environmental sustainability by reducing paper consumption. However, some educators argue that an overreliance on screens can cause eye strain, fatigue, and even disrupt sleep patterns due to prolonged exposure to blue light. Ultimately, the debate between digital and print reading is not

about choosing one over the other, but about achieving balance. Readers can enjoy the convenience of technology while still preserving the depth of traditional reading. By practising mindful reading—whether on paper or screen—individuals can ensure that technology enhances rather than weakens their intellectual engagement.

SSC CGL 13/09/2025 (Shift 3)

Q.26. What is the main concern raised about digital reading ?

(a) It is more expensive than printed books

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Comprehension

(b) It reduces deep engagement and comprehension

(c) It is unavailable in rural areas

(d) It discourages vocabulary development

Q.27. What advantage does according to the passage ?

(a) It increases paper usage

(b) It limits accessibility

(c) It provides portability and convenience

(d) It reduces technological dependency

digital reading offer

Q.28. What does the word “immersive” imply in the following

sentence from the passage ?

“Printed books, on the other hand, encourage focus and retention through a more immersive experience.”

(a) Distracting

(b) Deeply engaging

(c) Superficial

(d) Boring

Q.29. How does digital reading support environmental sustainability ?

(a) By reducing electricity use

(b) By promoting online advertisements

(c) By reducing paper consumption

(d) By recycling electronic waste

Q.30. What balance does the author suggest in the passage ?

(a) Completely avoiding digital reading

(b) Preferring printed books over everything

(c) Using both digital and print reading mindfully

(d) Replacing all books with e-readers

SET - 7 [Q .31. to Q .35.]

India’s journey in space exploration began in 1962 with the establishment of the Indian National Committee for Space Research (INCOSPAR) under the leadership of Dr. Vikram Sarabhai. What started with modest rocket launches from Thumba soon evolved into one of the world’s most respected space programs. The formation of the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) in 1969 marked a turning point, reflecting

India’s ambition to harness space technology for national development. Over the decades, ISRO achieved remarkable milestones — from launching the Aryabhata satellite in 1975 to the Chandrayaan and Mangalyaan missions that showcased India’s prowess in lunar and interplanetary exploration. However, the true transformation occurred in the 21st century. With the successful launch of the Chandrayaan-3 mission in 2023, India became the first nation to land on the Moon’s south pole, a feat celebrated
globally.
The mission highlighted ISRO’s
cost-effective innovation and technical expertise. Meanwhile, projects like Gaganyaan, India’s first human spaceflight program, signify the country's leap toward manned missions. ISRO’s collaborations with private space startups and global agencies are also expanding the frontiers of innovation, aiming to make India a key player in the global space economy. Yet, challenges persist — limited budgets, brain drain, and the need for continuous technological upgrades. Still, India’s space vision remains clear: to combine affordability, innovation, and global collaboration to reach new cosmic milestones.

SSC CGL 14/09/2025 (Shift 1)

Q.31. When was the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) established ?

(a) 1962 (b) 1969 (c) 1975 (d) 1984

Q.32. Which mission made India the first country to land on the

Moon’s south pole?

(a) Chandrayaan-2

(c) Chandrayaan-3

(b) Mangalyaan

(d) Gaganyaan

Q.33. What does the Gaganyaan project aim to achieve ?

(a) Launch India’s first Mars rover

(b) Conduct India’s first human spaceflight

(c) Build a permanent space station

(d) Launch low-cost communication satellites

Q.34. Which factor is NOT mentioned as a challenge for India’s space program ?

(a) Limited funding

(b) Brain drain

(c) Lack of public interest (d) Need for technological upgrades

Q.35. What best describes India’s long -term vision in space exploration ?

(a) To compete with Western nations at any cost

(b) To combine affordability, innovation, and collaboration

(c) To focus only on manned missions

(d) To depend entirely on foreign space agencies

SET - 8 [Q .36. to Q .40.]

In the contemporary era, the relationship between technology and human cognition has become increasingly intertwined. Digital tools have transformed how we process, store, and retrieve information. On one hand, technology enhances

efficiency — allowing instantaneous access to knowledge, fostering global communication, and enabling complex problem-solving. On the other hand, constant digital engagement has raised concerns about attention fragmentation, superficial learning, and declining memory retention. Psychologists argue that reliance on external devices for information storage—commonly termed as "digital amnesia"—may erode our natural cognitive abilities. When individuals delegate tasks like remembering phone numbers, dates, or even directions to devices, they strengthen convenience but weaken mental endurance. However, advocates of digital integration claim that such delegation allows the human mind to focus on higher-order thinking rather than routine recall.

They argue that every technological revolution—printing press, calculator, or computer—has similarly redefined intelligence rather than diminished it. The central challenge, therefore, is not resisting technology but using it judiciously—balancing cognitive independence

with

technological assistance. The future of human intellect will likely depend on how effectively individuals cultivate mindfulness in an age of mental automation.

SSC CGL 14/09/2025 (Shift 2)

Q.36. Which of the following best captures the essence of the passage ?

(a) Technology has made human cognition obsolete.

(b) Technology has both enhanced and challenged human cognition.

(c) Digital tools have replaced human intelligence.

(d) People should completely avoid dependence on technology.

Q.37. Which of the following is a concern raised by psychologists in the passage?

(a) Technology limits creativity and curiosity.

(b) Technology causes people to forget essential information.

(c) Technology has made learning too slow.

(d) Technology eliminates the need for education.

Q.38. How do advocates of digital integration defend technology

use?

(a) They believe technology replaces memory entirely.

(b) They argue it allows the mind to focus on complex thinking.

(c) They insist humans should rely solely on devices.

(d) They reject traditional intelligence models.

Q.39. What tone does the author adopt toward technological influence on human intellect ?

(a) Pessimistic and alarmist

(b) Balanced and reflective

(c) Sarcastic and dismissive

(d) Nostalgic and regretful

Q.40. What is the central concern raised in the passage ?

(a) Whether technology should replace human intelligence

(b) How to balance cognitive independence with technological reliance

(c) Why humans are addicted to devices

(d) When artificial intelligence will surpass human memory

SET - 9 [Q .41. to Q .45.]

The use of renewable energy has become a global priority as countries strive to reduce their dependence on fossil fuels. Renewable sources such as solar, wind, and hydroelectric power offer cleaner alternatives that help lower carbon emissions and combat climate change. However, the transition to renewable energy is not without challenges. The initial cost of setting up infrastructure remains high, and energy production can be inconsistent due to weather conditions. Despite these drawbacks, technological innovations are making renewable energy more efficient and affordable.

Governments are also encouraging the shift through subsidies,

tax incentives, and investment in research. These measures not only help reduce environmental damage but also create employment opportunities in new sectors. Public awareness about sustainability has further accelerated the demand for cleaner energy options. The future of global energy lies in a balanced approach—using renewable sources while continuing to improve storage technologies and grid efficiency. If nations maintain this momentum, renewable energy could soon replace conventional sources as the dominant form of power.

SSC CGL 14/09/2025 (Shift 3)

Q.41. What is the primary reason countries are adopting renewable energy sources?

(a) To increase energy prices

(b) To reduce carbon emissions

(c) To promote fossil fuel industries

(d) To decrease international cooperation

Q.42. What is one major challenge in the transition to renewable energy ?

(a) Lack of government interest

(b) High maintenance costs of fossil fuels

(c) High initial setup costs and inconsistent production

(d) Limited natural resources

Q.43. What role do governments play in promoting renewable energy ?

(a) They discourage innovation in renewable technology

(b) They provide financial and policy support to encourage its

use

(c) They restrict subsidies and incentives

(d) They depend solely on private companies

Q.44. What does the passage suggest about the future of global energy?

(a) It will rely only on fossil fuels

(b) It will depend entirely on hydroelectric power

(c) It will balance renewable and traditional sources

(d) It will eliminate all forms of technology

Q.45. What does the word “momentum” imply in the sentence “If nations maintain this momentum, renewable energy could soon replace conventional sources as the dominant form of power” ?

(a) Speed of technological change

(b) Ongoing progress and drive

(c) Sudden decline in interest

(d) Lack of stability

SET - 10 [Q .46. to Q .50.]

In the contemporary world, silence has become an anomaly-an absence that many mistake for emptiness rather than presence. Yet, silence is not the negation of sound but its most profound counterpoint. It is within silence that reflection finds its voice, that thoughts distill into clarity, and that creativity germinates. In an age dominated by incessant notifications, ceaseless commentary, and performative expression, the ability to be silent is increasingly radical. Philosophers from Lao Tzu to Wittgenstein have observed that language, though powerful,

often fractures experience into fragments that silence alone can reconcile. True understanding, therefore, may not always lie in articulation but in the spaces between words-the pauses that lend speech its meaning. Moreover, silence carries moral and emotional weight. It can soothe or wound, liberate or oppress. The silence of complicity sustains injustice, while the silence of contemplation heals. In relationships, silence can communicate intimacy or alienation, depending on intent and context. Thus, to master silence is not to abstain from speech but to discern when words enhance truth and when they obscure it. In learning to listen-to others, to nature, to ourselves-we recover a dimension of awareness long buried beneath the noise of modern life. Silence, then, is not absence but essence: the quiet pulse beneath the surface of existence that restores depth to being.

SSC CGL 15/09/2025 (Shift 1)

Q.46. According to the passage, the author views silence primarily as —

(a) A passive withdrawal from the world

(b) An essential component of understanding and awareness

(c) A sign of weakness or submission

(d) A threat to modern communication

Q.47. The author implies that excessive speech or noise in modern life:

(a) Leads to deeper empathy

(b) Enhances creative thinking

(c) Fragmentizes experience and diminishes reflection

(d) Strengthens social harmony

Q.48. Which of the following best captures the paradox of

silence as discussed in the passage?

(a) Silence both conceals and reveals truth.

(b) Silence is the absence of emotion.

(c) Silence is meaningless without speech.

(d) Silence is superior to all forms of expression.

Q.49. What tone does the author primarily adopt in the passage?

(a) Reflective and philosophical (b) Cynical and dismissive

(c) Playful and humorous

(d) Coldly analytical

Q.50. In the context of the passage, the word anomaly most

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nearly means:

(a) A deviation from the norm

(c) A universal pattern

SET - 11 [Q .51. to Q .55.]

(b) A hidden truth

(d) A minor interruption